

Cecilia Y. Sui

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Last updated: September 2026

Education	Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO	
	Ph.D. in Political Science	expected May 2027
	Committee: Jacob Montgomery (Co-Chair), Christopher Lucas (Co-Chair), Taylor Carlson, and Ted Enamorado	
	M.A. in Political Science	2025
	Lipscomb University, Nashville, TN	
	B.S. in Computer Science, minor in Political Science (<i>summa cum laude</i>)	2020
Publications	[1] Cecilia Y. Sui. “High Accuracy with Low Costs: The Pretrain-Finetune Paradigm for Classification with Transformer-Based Language Models.” <i>Political Science Research and Methods</i> , First View, 2026. [Paper]	
Working Papers	Job Market Paper	
	[1] Cecilia Y. Sui. “Should Candidates Campaign Like Influencers? Evidence From 16,572 Instagram Reels and Two Generative AI Video Experiments.” [Paper]	
	[2] Cecilia Y. Sui, Soyeon Jeon, Christopher Lucas, Jacob Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. “One Language is Enough: Using Transfer Learning to Detect Populist Rhetoric Across 25 Languages Without Translation.” Draft available upon request. <i>Research supported by NSF Award #2215008 and Carnegie Corporation of New York Grant #G-23-60440.</i>	
Work in Progress	[1] Cecilia Y. Sui. “Seeing Inside the Black Box: Feature Attribution for Political Text in the Age of Language Models.”	
	[2] Cecilia Y. Sui and Annie Jarman. “Gendered Costs of Influencer-Style Political Communication.” (<i>Co-first authors</i>).	
Grants & Awards	Awards	
	Antoinette Dames Prize for Best Graduate-Level Paper WashU \$3,000	2023
	External Research Support	
	National Science Foundation Award #2215008 \$571,005	2022–2024
	“Populist Rhetoric on Social Media and Its Effects on Democracies”	
	PIs: Jacob Montgomery, Christopher Lucas, and Margit Tavits.	
	Supports the first-authored paper “One Language is Enough: Using Transfer Learning to Detect Populist Rhetoric Across 25 Languages Without Translation.”	
	Carnegie Corporation of New York Grant #G-23-60440 \$330,000	2023–2025
	“The Role of International Cooperation in Combating the Populist Threat to Democracies”	
	PIs: Jacob Montgomery, Christopher Lucas, and Margit Tavits.	
	Supports the first-authored paper “One Language is Enough: Using Transfer Learning to Detect Populist Rhetoric Across 25 Languages Without Translation.”	
	Google Cloud Research Grant \$1,000	2025
	Internal Research Grants	
	Weidenbaum Center Research Grant on Non-Textual Political Communication, with Jacob Montgomery and Christopher Lucas \$9,365	2026
	Political Science Department Dissertation Seed Grant \$600	2026
	Dissertation Research Grant \$1,000	2025
	LSQ Research Grant \$5,000	2023

Travel Grants

Political Science Department Travel Grant \$700	2026
Political Science Department Travel Grant \$900	2025
Political Science Department Travel Grant \$900	2023
PolMeth NSF Summer Travel Grant \$900	2023
MPSA Travel Grant \$500	2023

Conferences & Talks**Invited Talk**

Peking University (PKU Analytics Lab for Global Risk Politics)	2023
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Conference Presentations

Midwest Association for Public Opinion Research — paper (scheduled)	2026
American Political Science Association Annual Meeting — paper	2025, 2026
Annual Conference of the Society for Political Methodology 2023 poster · 2025 paper · 2026 poster	2023, 2025, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association Conference — paper	2022, 2023, 2026

Teaching Experience**Independent Instructor**

Introduction to Python (Graduate)	Summer 2023
Introduction to R Programming (Graduate)	Winter 2022

Assistant Instructor

Quantitative Political Methodology (Undergraduate; Ted Enamorado)	Spring 2023
Quantitative Political Methodology II (Graduate; Jacob Montgomery)	Fall 2022
Introduction to Python (Graduate; Annamaria Prati)	Summer 2022
Quantitative Political Methodology I (Graduate; Ted Enamorado)	Spring 2022
Mathematical Modeling (Graduate; Ted Enamorado)	Fall 2021

Research Experience

Research Assistant Jacob Montgomery and Christopher Lucas, WashU	2023–2024
Research Assistant Taylor Carlson and Carly Wayne, WashU	2021–2022

Service

Moderator, PolMeth ListServ	2023–2024
Department Graduate Student Mentor	2023

Skills

Languages: Mandarin Chinese, English
Programming: R, Python, HTML/CSS, Java, C, SQL, LaTeX
APIs & Tools: Twitter, TikTok, Meta Content Library, OpenAI, Claude Code, Azure, Amazon Mechanical Turk, Hugging Face, Upwork, Qualtrics, Prolific

References**Jacob Montgomery**

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